BUSINESS PROPOSAL · PAYMENTS MODERNIZATION

The 2027 Operator Transfer Upgrade

A milestone plan for how tour operators get paid on bookings for 2027 and beyond — built for clarity, safety, and a rollout you can control every step of the way.

PROJECT PROPOSAL · MILESTONE PLAN

Prepared for
NAT Leadership

Prepared by
Product & Engineering

Date
September 2026

Applies to
Tours departing 2027 onward

EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

Why we're doing this

An upgrade that unlocks single-payment checkout across multiple tour operators — without changing what guests see, what operators earn, or how anything is priced.

Today, when a guest pays for a tour, our payment processor splits that single payment automatically — but only ever to **one** tour operator's account. That's a hard technical limit of how card payments work today, not a business choice: a single charge can only ever settle to a single connected account.

That limit is exactly what's stood in the way of a true **NAT Network checkout** — a guest buying tour packages from several different operators in one single payment. For any tour **departing in 2027 or later**, we're changing how the charge settles: the full payment lands with NAT first, and NAT's own systems then send each operator their exact share as its own explicit step. Because that step is ours to control, it's no longer limited to one operator — a single guest payment can now be distributed across as many operators as the cart actually contains.

This also gives our own team a clearer, first-class record of every operator payment, instead of it happening invisibly inside the payment processor's own settlement — improving visibility and our ability to react quickly if anything ever needs attention.



One Checkout, Many Operators

A single guest payment can now be split across every operator in a combo cart — not just one.



Full Visibility

Every operator transfer becomes its own recorded event NAT can see, trace, and report on — not a hidden side effect.



Zero Guest Impact

Guests check out exactly the same way, on every device, with no visible change whatsoever.



Safe, Reversible Rollout

A dedicated on/off control means we can turn this on gradually, and instantly back off if anything looks wrong.

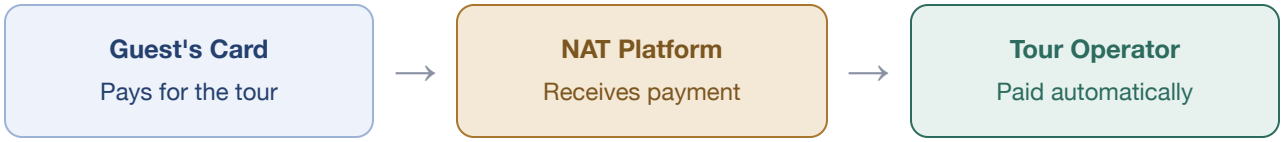
> *"Nothing about the guest experience, operator earnings, or booking price changes. What's new is what becomes possible — one payment, many operators — with full visibility into every transfer along the way."*

HOW IT WORKS

Today, versus what we're proposing

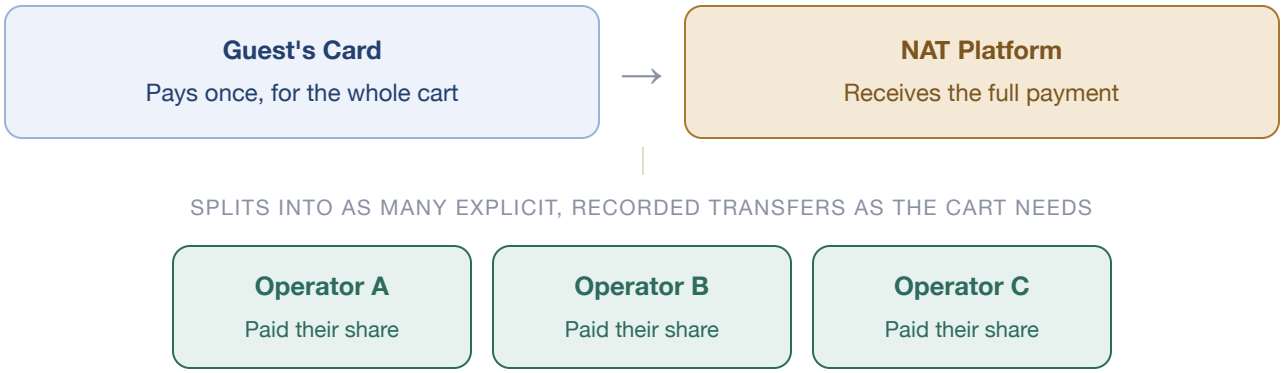
Two payment calls instead of one — fired back to back, at the exact same moment. Because the second call is ours to make, it can go to more than one operator, not just one.

TODAY · EVERY BOOKING, EVERY TOUR DATE



Our payment processor performs the split as one single, automatic step — but only ever to one operator's account. A cart spanning multiple operators has no clean way to settle today.

PROPOSED · TOURS DEPARTING 2027 AND LATER, ONLY



NAT's own systems now explicitly send each operator their share as its own event — the same moment as today, recorded and traceable, and no longer limited to a single operator per payment.

Why now?

As of today, **no tour dated 2027 or later has been booked or sold anywhere on the platform yet.** That gives us a rare, completely risk-free window: we can build and thoroughly test this upgrade quietly, in the background, with zero chance of disrupting a real guest or a booking already in progress. The only real deadline is having this fully in place before the first 2027 tour date is ever opened for sale on any operator's calendar — not January 1, 2027 itself, which has no bearing on booking dates.

SET EXPECTATIONS

What stays exactly the same

This upgrade is intentionally narrow. Everything below continues to work precisely as it does today.

Unchanged, guaranteed

- Guests check out exactly the same way, on web, mobile, and in person.
- Operators are paid at the exact same moment as today — nothing is delayed or held back.
- Every booking for a tour dated 2026 or earlier is completely unaffected, forever.
- Pricing, fees, and commission splits are calculated exactly as they are today.

Built on proven technology

NAT's platform already uses this exact payment-splitting approach successfully today, for a different kind of booking — multi-operator partner tours. This project takes that same trusted, working approach and extends it to cover 2027+ bookings too. We are reusing a pattern that already works, not inventing one from scratch — which meaningfully lowers the risk of this project before we've written a line of it.

Scope, in one sentence

This upgrade covers **card and card-reader payments only**, for tours departing in **2027 or later**. It does not touch cash, check, or other offline payment records, and it does not touch the separate system that already pays tour guides their own gratuities.

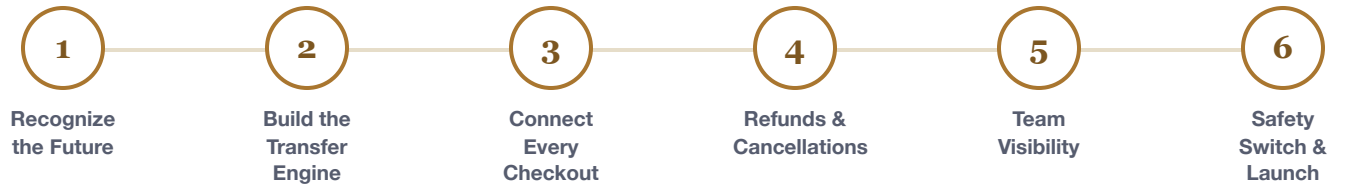
Our commitment to you

- Every change is tested against a real booking scenario before it's considered complete — not just reviewed on paper.
- No booking for a tour dated 2026 or earlier is ever touched by this work, at any point, in any milestone.
- You'll hear from us as each milestone completes — a short, plain-language update, not a lengthy status meeting.

THE PLAN

Six milestones, start to finish

Each milestone is a complete, testable unit of work. We move to the next only once the current one is solid.



1 **Recognize the Future**
Teach the system to spot a 2027+ booking the instant it's paid for, and permanently record which payment method applies to it.

2 **Build the New Transfer Engine**
Build the mechanism that sends an operator their share as its own clear, recorded step — modeled on a proven pattern already in use elsewhere.

3 **Connect Every Way Guests Can Pay**
Roll the new method out across every checkout flow — web, mobile, admin, and in-person card readers — one at a time, each fully tested.

4 **Make Refunds & Cancellations Just Work**
Ensure a cancellation, refund, or dispute correctly and safely reverses a 2027+ operator transfer, exactly as it already does today.

5 **Give Our Team Visibility**
Surface any transfer that didn't go through cleanly, so our team can follow up — instead of it going unnoticed.

6 **A Safety Switch, and a Careful Launch**
Add a controllable on/off switch, rehearse everything in a safe test environment, and launch gradually with an instant way back.

MILESTONE ONE · FOUNDATION

Recognize the Future

01

Before we can change how an operator is paid, the system needs to reliably recognize *which* bookings this even applies to — and remember that decision permanently, so it can never be second-guessed later, even if a trip gets rescheduled.

WHAT THIS INVOLVES

- A simple internal rule that checks a booking's tour date the moment payment is taken.
- A permanent record attached to every transaction, noting which payment method applies to it — written once, never rewritten.
- Safe, conservative handling for multi-tour "combo cart" purchases, so a single order mixing 2026 and 2027 tours is never handled ambiguously.

YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING WHEN

Every new booking, from the instant it's paid for, is correctly and permanently tagged — with zero manual involvement, and no way for that tag to be lost or overwritten later, even by a rescheduled trip date.

IN PRACTICE

A guest books a 2029 kayaking trip today. The moment they pay, the system quietly notes "this one uses the new method" — a decision that never changes again, even if the trip date is later moved.

MILESTONE TWO · CORE ENGINE

Build the New Transfer Engine

02

This is the heart of the upgrade: the actual mechanism that sends a tour operator their share of a booking, built as its own clear, distinct step — modeled closely on a payment-splitting tool NAT already relies on successfully today for its partner-commission bookings.

WHAT THIS INVOLVES

- A dedicated internal process that calculates the operator's share and sends it as its own distinct, trackable transaction.
- A permanent internal ledger entry for every transfer — success or failure — that our team can look back on later.
- Careful handling so a rare failed transfer is safely logged, never silently lost, and never accidentally charges the guest twice or blocks their booking.

YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING WHEN

Every 2027+ booking generates a clear, separate, auditable transfer record — visible internally the moment it happens, success or failure alike.

IN PRACTICE

When that same 2029 booking is confirmed, the new transfer engine sends the operator's share as its own clearly logged transaction — separate from, but at the exact same instant as, the guest's payment.

MILESTONE THREE · PLATFORM-WIDE ROLLOUT

Connect Every Way Guests Can Pay

03

Guests can pay in many different ways today — booking online, paying a remaining balance, adding extras, tipping, paying in person with a card reader, using the mobile app, and more. This milestone updates every one of those moments so they all correctly use the new method for 2027+ bookings.

WHAT THIS INVOLVES

- Auditing every place across the website, admin dashboard, mobile app, and point-of-sale devices where a payment can be taken.
- Updating each one individually, with its own dedicated test, before moving on to the next.
- Leaving every other flow — gift cards, cash, offline payments, and anything for a tour before 2027 — completely untouched.

YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING WHEN

No matter how or where a guest pays for a 2027+ tour, the new transfer method is used correctly and automatically, every single time.

IN PRACTICE

Whether that guest paid on the website, over the phone with a card reader, or through the mobile app, the outcome is identical — the new method applies consistently, everywhere a payment can happen.

MILESTONE FOUR · REFUND & DISPUTE SAFETY NET

Make Refunds & Cancellations Just Work

04

When a guest cancels, requests a refund, or disputes a charge, the operator's earlier transfer needs to be safely and correctly pulled back — matching exactly how refunds already work today, just adapted to the new payment method.

WHAT THIS INVOLVES

- Updating every refund and cancellation flow across the platform to correctly reverse a 2027+ booking's transfer.
- Special handling for partial refunds, so only the correct, proportional share is ever pulled back.
- Extending the same protection to chargeback and dispute cases, so a lost dispute is always handled safely.

YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING WHEN

A refund, cancellation, or dispute on a 2027+ booking behaves exactly as guests and operators already expect — the right amount, landing in the right place, every time.

IN PRACTICE

If that same guest later cancels and receives a partial refund, only the operator's fair share of that refund is pulled back — automatically and correctly, without anyone needing to calculate it by hand.

MILESTONE FIVE · INTERNAL REPORTING

Give Our Team Visibility

05

On the rare occasion a transfer to an operator doesn't go through — for example, if their bank account needs attention — NAT's own team should be able to see it clearly and follow up, rather than it going unnoticed.

WHAT THIS INVOLVES

- A simple internal view highlighting any transfer that didn't complete successfully.
- Enough detail for someone on the team to understand which booking and which operator are affected.
- A clear path to follow up manually and resolve it, without digging through raw logs.

YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING WHEN

A failed transfer is never a silent, invisible problem — it shows up somewhere a real person on the team will see it.

IN PRACTICE

If an operator's bank details ever cause a transfer to stumble, it appears on an internal list our team already checks — not buried in a system log no one reads.

MILESTONE SIX · ROLLOUT CONTROLS & GO-LIVE

A Safety Switch, and a Careful Launch

06

The final milestone is about how we turn this on — gradually, safely, and with a way to instantly turn it back off if anything ever looks wrong, after a full rehearsal in a completely safe test environment.

WHAT THIS INVOLVES

- A simple on/off control, adjustable per operator or region, so rollout can start small and expand deliberately.
- A complete rehearsal in Stripe's test environment — simulating real bookings, refunds, and edge cases before go-live.
- A clear rollback plan, so the platform can instantly fall back to today's method with zero guest impact, if ever needed.

YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING WHEN

The switch can be flipped on for one operator at a time, watched closely, and confidently expanded — with an instant way back if ever needed.

IN PRACTICE

We might start by turning this on for a single, closely-watched operator. If everything looks right, we expand from there — and if it doesn't, we flip it back off instantly, with no visible change for anyone.

MOVING FORWARD

Recommended next steps

We recommend building and confirming each milestone in order — each one is independently useful and independently testable, so progress stays visible throughout.

Let's get started

Once you've had a chance to review this plan, we're ready to begin with Milestone 1. Because no 2027-dated tour has been sold yet, this work can proceed entirely in the background, with zero risk to any current guest or booking.

1. Review this plan and share any questions or adjustments.
2. We begin with Milestone 1, and check in as each milestone completes.

How we'll keep you posted

After each milestone is complete and tested, you'll get a short, plain-language update — what's now working, and what's next. No lengthy status meetings required unless you'd like them.

We're looking forward to building this with you.

Devat Karetha
Solutions Lead